

soft's guidance to set paper-white and peak brightness for your panel.

- **Windows PCs (for HTPCs or gaming rigs):** Use Microsoft's Windows HDR Calibration app and calibrate in your actual room lighting.

Tip: If you changed picture modes after calibrating (e.g., switching to "Game" mode), re-run HDR calibration for that mode too.

B. Turn on the right TV features for smooth motion and sound

- **Game Mode / VRR / 120 Hz:** Enable your TV's low-latency "Game" mode and VRR where supported; then select 120 Hz output on console/PC to reduce input lag and jitter. (See your TV's HDMI 2.1/VRR section.)
- **eARC for lossless soundbars/AVRs:** If your TV and soundbar/AVR support eARC, connect the TV's eARC HDMI to the audio device's eARC port and enable eARC in both menus. eARC carries high-bit-rate formats (up to 24-bit/192 kHz and ~37 Mbit/s), including object-based audio, over that single HDMI link.

C. Apple TV colour balance (bonus)

If you use an Apple TV 4K, try Settings ▶ Video and Audio ▶ Colour Balance to quickly nudge color accuracy using a Face ID iPhone as the sensor. It's not a pro calibration, but it's a fast, repeatable improvement.



Speaker & sub sanity check: 20 mins

Even great gear underperforms if it's sitting wrong. Do a rapid layout review using the manufacturer-approved maps:

- **Surround/Atmos placement:** Follow Dolby's diagrams for 5.1/7.1 and Atmos height speakers; if you can run four overheads instead of two, localization and envelopment improve noticeably.
- **Height channel pragmatism:** If true in-ceiling isn't possible, consider Atmos-enabled up-firing modules placed atop your L/R speakers; aim them per Dolby's angles to avoid ceiling hotspots.

- **Quick fix:** Re-run your AVR/soundbar's auto-calibration after any move, then trim the center channel +1 to +2 dB if dialogue still feels recessed. (Most brands support per-channel trims.)

Reliability before "more gear"

Multi-room audio, 4K HDR streaming, and cloud gaming all lean on your Wi-Fi. If your home is large or has thick walls, consider mesh with Ethernet backhaul – wiring your main nodes together – so wireless speakers/TVs aren't fighting for bandwidth. Google explicitly documents how to hard-wire Nest Wifi/Nest Wifi Pro/Google Wifi nodes to stabilize throughput.

- **Two high-impact tweaks:** (1) wire the TV/AVR/soundbar to the nearest node; (2) keep streaming devices on 5/6 GHz SSIDs where possible so 2.4 GHz is free for IoT. (Mesh vendors and community guides highlight backhaul wiring as the single biggest stability win.)

Listen longer, not louder

Cinematic sound is fun – hearing loss is not. The WHO advises that ~80 dB exposure is safe for up to ~40 hours/week, but as you push toward 90 dB, safe time collapses to ~4 hours/week. Keep overall volume sensible, and use Night/Dynamic Range modes after 10 pm.

- **Rule of thumb:** If conversations in the room require raised voices over your TV, you're likely above safe long-term levels. (Many audiology groups place "generally safe" everyday exposure at ~70 dB.)

Save energy (and money) without losing quality

When you replace or add displays, look for India's BEE star-label; newer labels include clearer efficiency info and QR codes to verify claims. TVs with higher star ratings typically sip less power for the same brightness level – useful in multi-device homes.

- **Practical tweaks today:** Use "Eco" or "Power Saving" outside of movie night, dim backlights a notch for daytime news/sports, and enable auto-sleep timers on streaming dongles and consoles.

